Charlotte Hughes

Financial Analyst — Corporate Finance and FP&A

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Corporate finance and FP&A professional with 11 years of experience in consumer goods, hospitality, and industrial engineering businesses. Owns three-statement financial models, rolling forecasts, and annual budgets, and turns them into decisions for CFOs and regional leaders. Improved three-month revenue forecast accuracy from ±6.5% to ±2.8% and shortened the annual budget cycle from 14 to 9 weeks by moving from linked workbooks to Anaplan. Combines Excel modelling with SQL and Power BI so that commentary rests on reconciled data rather than manual extracts. Known for clear presentations to non-finance stakeholders, with a strong interest in driver-based planning and scenario analysis.

ANALYTICAL AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Financial modelling: Three-statement models, driver-based forecasting, rolling forecasts, capital expenditure appraisal (NPV, IRR, payback), scenario and sensitivity analysis.

Forecasting and budgeting: Annual budget process design, zero-based budgeting, cost-centre planning, 13-week cash flow forecasting, working capital analysis.

Accounting and financial statements: Management accounts, month-end close support, accruals and prepayments, balance sheet reconciliations, variance analysis, IFRS-based reporting.

Valuation: Discounted cash flow for investment cases and business case evaluation. Working knowledge: comparable-company analysis.

Programming and data analytics: Advanced: Microsoft Excel (complex models, Power Query), SQL. Working knowledge: Python (pandas).

Business intelligence and reporting: Power BI dashboards, monthly CFO packs, gross margin bridges (price, volume, mix, FX, input costs), KPI design.

Finance systems: Anaplan, SAP S/4HANA reporting, Oracle NetSuite.

Industry experience: Fast-moving consumer goods, hospitality, industrial engineering.

Communication: Board and CFO presentations, budget-holder training, finance business partnering.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ashgrove Consumer Brands (consumer goods) — London, United Kingdom

FP&A Lead (Senior Financial Analyst until 2023) — *Mar 2021 – Present*

- Own the group three-statement model and rolling 18-month forecast for a GBP 640 million revenue business across four regions; improved three-month revenue forecast accuracy from ±6.5% to ±2.8%.
- Redesigned the annual budget process for 22 cost-centre owners and moved planning from linked Excel workbooks to Anaplan, shortening the cycle from 14 to 9 weeks and removing most version-control errors.
- Built a driver-based gross margin bridge that separates price, volume, mix, foreign exchange, and input cost effects, presented monthly to the CFO and regional general managers.
- Modelled scenarios for a 20% rise in packaging and dairy costs with treasury and procurement, informing a pricing and hedging plan that protected about 1.2 points of gross margin.
- Built SQL queries and Power BI dashboards that prepare variance data automatically, cutting monthly reporting preparation from four days to two.

Penrose Hospitality Group (hotels) — Manchester, United Kingdom

Financial Analyst — *Aug 2017 – Feb 2021*

- Prepared investment appraisals (NPV, IRR, payback) for 12 hotel refurbishment projects totalling GBP 38 million and presented recommendations to the investment committee.
- Built a 13-week cash flow forecast during the 2020 closures, used weekly by the CFO to manage liquidity, supplier payments, and lender reporting.
- Supported month-end close for 18 hotels through accruals review, balance sheet reconciliations, and variance commentary.

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- Developed a hotel-level profitability model linking occupancy, average daily rate, and labour costs, used in quarterly business reviews.

Calder Engineering plc (industrial engineering) Leeds, United Kingdom
Graduate Finance Analyst *Sep 2015 – Jul 2017*

- Completed rotations in management accounting, financial control, and commercial finance on a two-year graduate programme.
- Automated monthly overhead allocations in Excel, saving one working day each month.
- Supported contract margin reviews on long-term engineering projects with project managers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

SKU profitability model
Tools and methods: Excel, Power Query, SQL, Power BI, cost-to-serve allocation

- **Problem:** Product-level margins ignored logistics and promotion costs, which hid loss-making products.
- **Contribution:** Built a cost-to-serve allocation model with the supply chain team and documented every allocation assumption.
- **Result:** Identified 140 low-margin SKUs; the rationalisation plan improved contribution margin by about GBP 3.4 million per year.

Zero-based budgeting pilot for marketing
Tools and methods: Anaplan, Excel, zero-based budgeting

- **Problem:** Marketing budgets rolled forward each year without linking spend to outcomes.
- **Contribution:** Designed templates and review sessions that linked each spend line to a measurable objective.
- **Result:** Reallocated 9% of the marketing budget to higher-return channels in the pilot year.

Working capital improvement programme
Tools and methods: SQL, Excel, Power BI, ageing and payment-behaviour analysis

- **Problem:** Debtor days had risen for three consecutive quarters.
- **Contribution:** Built a customer-level ageing and payment-behaviour analysis for the credit control team.
- **Result:** Debtor days fell from 52 to 44, releasing about GBP 11 million of cash.

EDUCATION

University of Thamesford London, United Kingdom
B.Sc. Economics and Accounting *2012 – 2015*

- First-class honours; dissertation on forecast bias in UK consumer goods companies.
- Coursework: financial accounting, corporate finance, econometrics, management accounting.

HACKATHONS, CONFERENCES, AND PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Northern FP&A Forum, London (2025)** — Panel speaker on moving from spreadsheet budgeting to connected planning.
- **Corporate Finance Modelling Challenge, London (2018)** — Participant; built a leveraged acquisition model and investment case under time pressure.
- **University of Thamesford alumni mentoring (2020 – Present)** — Mentors economics students interested in corporate finance careers.

CERTIFICATIONS AND ADDITIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Professional development (illustrative): Advanced Financial Modelling Certificate, Northbridge Finance Institute (2019); Connected Planning Practitioner Course, Northbridge Finance Institute (2021).

Leadership: Trains new budget holders each year on forecasting templates and planning timelines.

Languages: English (native), French (professional working proficiency).

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